

HOUSE RESOLUTION 65

By Parkinson

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Richard Ransom of Memphis.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Richard Ransom, a highly respected journalist, television news anchor, and community advocate who has enriched the lives of the citizens in the Memphis area for many years; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Ransom's journey began in Peoria, Illinois, moving on to Jacksonville, Florida, before ultimately landing in Memphis; apart from a three-year stint in Milwaukee, Wisconsin, he has dedicated nearly his entire professional life to being a trusted information source for the citizens of Bluff City, earning numerous Emmy awards for his outstanding contributions to journalism along the way; and

WHEREAS, his career started as a researcher for the ABC News London bureau, a role that laid the foundation for his passion for storytelling and investigative reporting; and

WHEREAS, during his time at WATN-TV in Memphis, Richard Ransom has been a cornerstone of the newsroom, breaking major stories, conducting exclusive interviews, and sharing his wealth of institutional knowledge; his leadership and unwavering commitment have made him a trusted voice for both routine and breaking news coverage; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Ransom's enthusiasm for politics has shone through his role as a host for statewide televised debates, including those for U.S. Senate and Tennessee gubernatorial races; most recently, he earned widespread acclaim for moderating what many considered the standout debate of the Memphis mayoral race; and

WHEREAS, he also had the honor of interviewing President Barack Obama at the White House, a highlight of his already illustrious career; and

WHEREAS, Richard Ransom revitalized ABC 24's *This Week*, transforming it into a must-watch program for both viewers and community leaders; and

WHEREAS, with authenticity at the heart of his work, Mr. Ransom has been deeply committed to presenting a balanced and honest portrayal of Memphis, particularly when addressing the complexities of crime; rejecting the "crime all the time" narrative, he has championed transparency and context, ensuring viewers receive the full story; and

WHEREAS, he has also been a vocal advocate for the community, holding politicians accountable and celebrating the generosity of Memphians through initiatives such as the "Pass It On" segment; his efforts to improve public health standards, including urging local restaurants to "Clean Up!" after health inspection failures, have further cemented his legacy; and

WHEREAS, Richard Ransom epitomizes the spirit and commitment to community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Ransom's dedication to journalism has inspired his colleagues and elevated the standards of reporting in Memphis, and it is our privilege to recognize his important contributions to this State and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend Richard Ransom for his countless contributions to journalism and his service to the citizens of Memphis, extending to him our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.